



Motorcycle could carry three soldiers and their weapons at speeds up to 59 mph (95 km/h)

Cannister, with the bike fitted inside, is just 13 in (33 cm) in diameter

Parachute



Welbike UK 1942

BSA M20 UK 1942



Rear-wheel canvas panniers

A
Welbike
could be put
together in just
11 seconds.

Holster to hold rifle or machine gun



Harley-Davidson WLA USA 1942

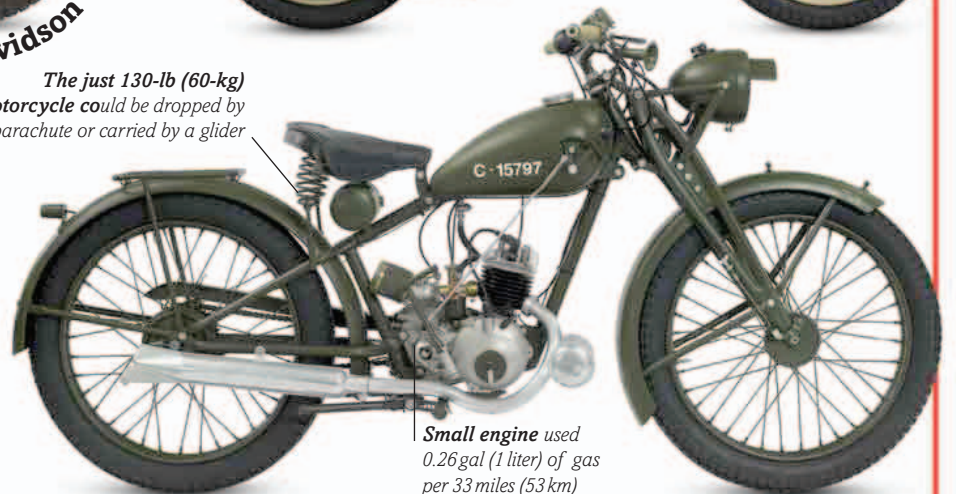
Norton 16H Desert Duty UK 1942



Metal sheet "bash plate" to protect engine



The just 130-lb (60-kg) motorcycle could be dropped by parachute or carried by a glider



Small engine used 0.26 gal (1 liter) of gas per 33 miles (53 km)

Royal Enfield WD/RE125 Flying Flea UK 1948

built in Japan, the **Rikuo Type 97** served Japanese forces during wartime. Its sidecar was engine-powered, improving travel over rough ground, a feature also found in the sidecar of the **Norton Big Four**, used as a scout by British soldiers. The 930-lb (420-kg) **Zundapp KS750**

was one of the biggest World War II sidecars. In contrast, the 71-lb (32-kg) **Welbike** could be folded inside a cannister, dropped from a plane, and parachuted to the ground. Another lightweight, the **Flying Flea** was used to carry messages when radio contact was impossible.